Half of a Window Leaf

From the madrasa of Bashir Agha al-Jumdar

Bahri Mamluk, 760-61 AH / 1359-60 CE

W: 37 cm; H: 64 cm

Inv. no. 3511



Half of a window leaf acquired from the madrasa of Bashir Agha al-Jumdar (760-61 AH / 1359-60 CE), a Mamluk amir and master of robes (jumdar) under Sultan Hassan (r. 755-62 AH / 1354-61 CE). Its central geometric design consists of six-pointed stars and hexagons, a widely employed combination in the artistic vocabulary of medieval Cairene woodwork from the Tulunid period onwards. Traces of simple

carved decoration survive in some of the joinery pieces, and a surrounding border is carved in relief with vegetal scrolls. The panel forms part of a limited corpus of surviving architectural fittings from the now-ruined madrasa, which contemporary sources describe as having been a charming structure.

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